

Week 1 — Reawaken the body

Get moving without injury · Rebuild the habit · No soreness that stops the next session

Duration 15–25 min/day	Intensity Very low — 3/10	Equipment None	Active days 5 of 7
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Monday	Walk + breathe	20 min
Brisk walk outdoors or indoors	Flat surface, comfortable pace. Not fast.	20 min continuous
4-7-8 breathing (standing)	4 counts in · 7 hold · 8 out	5 rounds
Gentle neck and shoulder rolls	Slow, 5 each direction	2 min
Note: This is your only session today. 15 min is fine. Just move.		

Tuesday	Morning mobility	15 min
Cat-cow stretch	On hands and knees. Slow inhale up, exhale arch.	10 reps
Child's pose with side reach	Hold 30 sec each side	3 rounds
Hip circles (standing)	Hands on hips, wide slow circles	10 each direction
Ankle rolls + wrist rolls	Joints need waking after months off	10 each
Note: No sweat expected. This is joint care, not cardio.		

Wednesday	Gentle yoga	20 min
Mountain pose + breathing	Standing tall, aware of posture	2 min
Standing forward fold	Knees slightly bent, hang loose. No forcing.	Hold 45 sec x3
Low lunge (Anjaneyasana)	Both sides. Hip flexor opener.	30 sec each x2
Seated spinal twist	Both sides. Slow breath.	30 sec each side
Legs up the wall	Lie on back, legs up wall. Breathe slowly.	5 min
Note: YouTube: Adriene Mishler "Yoga for Beginners" works perfectly this week.		

Thursday	Walk + stretch	25 min
Brisk walk	Try slightly faster than Monday	20 min
Standing quad stretch	Hold wall for balance. Each leg.	30 sec x2 each
Calf raises (standing)	Rise onto toes slowly, lower slowly	10 reps x2
Note: Notice how it feels compared to Monday. It should feel easier already.		

Friday	Full body stretch	20 min
Supine knee-to-chest	Both knees, then alternate. Lower back release.	45 sec x3
Piriformis stretch (figure-4)	Lying on back. Each side.	45 sec each x2
Chest opener	Hands clasped behind back, gentle squeeze.	30 sec x3
Thoracic rotation (seated)	Hands on shoulders, rotate upper body.	10 each side
Note: Active recovery — it counts as training. Flexibility is being rebuilt.		
Saturday	Longer walk	25 min
Walk — slightly hilly route if possible	Or treadmill at 5% incline	25 min
Post-walk stretch	Hamstrings, calves, hip flexors	5 min
Note: Weekend — most active day this week. Still low intensity.		
Sunday	Complete rest	—
No structured exercise	Gentle walk to get groceries is fine	Optional
Diary: write how Week 1 felt	Note energy levels, soreness, mood changes	10 min
Note: Rest is training. Body rebuilds on rest days. Sleep 7–8 hrs tonight.		
Week 1 rule	If you feel muscle soreness after a session, it was too hard. Back off. Stop before you feel tired, not after. PCOS fatigue and anemia mean your recovery is slower than average. The goal this week is to feel energised after — not depleted.	

Week 2 — Build the foundation

Introduce bodyweight strength · Find your baseline · Establish the morning routine

Duration	Intensity	Equipment	Active days
25–35 min/day	Low — 4/10	None — bodyweight only	5 of 7
Monday	Lower body — bodyweight	30 min	
Bodyweight squat	Feet shoulder-width. Sit back into heels. Chair height.	3 x 10 reps	
Glute bridge	Lie on back, feet flat, push hips up. Squeeze glutes at top.	3 x 12 reps	
Standing calf raises	Slow up, slow down. Hold wall if needed.	2 x 15 reps	
Wall sit	Back flat on wall, knees 90 degrees. Hold.	2 x 20 seconds	
Note: Rest 60 sec between sets. If squats hurt knees, make them shallower. Depth comes with time.			
Tuesday	Yoga + breathwork	25 min	
Nadi Shodhana (alternate nostril breathing)	5 min. Calms nervous system. Best anxiety intervention.	5 min	
Sun salutation — very slow, modified	1–2 rounds only. Skip downward dog if wrists hurt.	2 rounds	
Warrior I and II hold	Each side. Leg strength + hip flexor stretch.	30 sec each x2	
Seated forward fold	Legs straight, reach toward feet. Do not force.	Hold 45 sec x3	
Note: The breathwork directly reduces cortisol — prioritise it.			
Wednesday	Upper body + core	30 min	
Wall push-up	Hands on wall, lean forward. Smart starting point.	3 x 12 reps	
Incline push-up (hands on table)	Only if wall push-ups feel too easy	3 x 8 reps	
Dead bug	Lie on back, arms up. Lower opposite arm+leg. Back must not arch.	3 x 6 each side	
Superman hold	Lie face down, lift arms and legs. Hold 3 sec.	3 x 8 reps	
Shoulder rolls + arm circles	Warm-down for upper body	2 min	
Note: Core exercises before crunches — dead bug and superman build deep stabilisers.			
Thursday	Active recovery walk	30 min	
Brisk walk	Conversational pace — full sentences while walking	25 min	
Post-walk full body stretch	Quads, hamstrings, calves, chest, shoulders	5 min	
Note: Between two strength days. Keep it easy. Hydrate well — 2–3L today.			

Friday	Full body — bodyweight	30 min
Squat to calf raise	Squat down, stand up, rise onto toes. One fluid movement.	3 x 10 reps
Glute bridge march	Hold bridge position, alternate lifting each foot 2 inches.	3 x 8 each side
Wall push-up	Same as Wednesday — aim for cleaner form	3 x 12 reps
Bird-dog	On all fours, extend opposite arm+leg. Back flat.	3 x 8 each side
Standing side reach stretch	Cool down. Each side.	30 sec x3
Note: Full body day — same movements as Mon and Wed combined. Intentional.		
Saturday	Yin yoga	35 min
Butterfly pose (Baddha Konasana)	Soles of feet together, lean forward.	3 min hold
Dragon pose (deep lunge)	Each side. Hip flexors — crucial for PCOS pelvic health.	2 min each side
Sleeping swan / pigeon	Each side. Emotional release is normal here.	2 min each
Supine twist	Each side. Digestion + detox twist.	2 min each
Savasana with body scan	Full relaxation. Do not skip.	5 min
Note: Yin yoga targets connective tissue, held 2–3 min per pose. Harder than it looks.		
Sunday	Rest + reflect	—
Gentle walk only if desired	No structured session	Optional 15 min
Note Week 2 progress in diary	Which was easy? Which was hard? Write it.	10 min
Note: End of Week 2. You should feel a slight change in energy and sleep quality.		
Week 2 rule	Every rep should feel controlled and easy — if you are shaking or straining, stop. Slow down: 3 seconds down, pause, 2 seconds up. Tempo is your training tool this week, not load. Rest 60–90 seconds between sets. No rushing.	

Week 3 — Build strength

Increase sets and reps · Add resistance band · Begin to feel like a real workout

Duration 35–45 min/day	Intensity Moderate — 5–6/10	Equipment Resistance loop band (buy this week)	Active days 6 of 7
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Monday	Lower body + band	40 min
Resistance band squat	Band above knees. Pushes knees out, activates glutes.	3 x 12 reps
Romanian deadlift — bodyweight	Feet hip-width, hinge at hips, back flat.	3 x 10 reps
Lateral band walk	Band above knees, half-squat position, step sideways.	3 x 12 steps each way
Single-leg glute bridge	One foot on floor, other leg bent up.	3 x 8 each side
Standing figure-4 balance	Hip opener + balance training. Hold wall if needed.	30 sec each x2
Note: The band changes everything — glutes and outer hips activate properly.		

Tuesday	Yoga — strength flow	35 min
Kapalabhati pranayama (gentle)	Short sharp exhales. 30 breaths. Energising.	3 rounds
Chair pose hold (Utkatasana)	Feet together, arms up, sit into imaginary chair.	Hold 30 sec x4
Warrior II to Reverse Warrior flow	Each side. Strength + flexibility combo.	5 flows each side
Boat pose (modified)	Lean back, knees bent, feet off floor.	Hold 15 sec x4
Bridge pose hold	Arms alongside body, hold at top.	Hold 30 sec x3
Note: This is strength yoga, not relaxation yoga. You should feel your muscles working.		

Wednesday	Upper body + core + band	40 min
Knee push-up (floor)	Knees on floor, straight line from knee to head.	3 x 10 reps
Band pull-apart	Hold band with both hands, arms straight, pull wide.	3 x 15 reps
Plank hold (forearms)	Straight line. Do not let hips sag or rise.	3 x 20 seconds
Dead bug (harder)	Extend leg fully toward floor — do not let it touch.	3 x 8 each side
Band overhead press (seated)	Sit on floor, band under legs, press overhead.	3 x 12 reps
Note: Week 3 is when it first feels like a workout. Stick to plan — people overdo it here.		

Thursday	Walk — hills or incline	35 min
Walk with hills or 5 degree treadmill incline	Conversational pace on harder terrain	30 min
Post-walk stretch sequence	Hip flexors, calves, hamstrings, chest	5 min
Note: Incline walking is low-impact lower body cardio — kinder on joints than running.		
Friday	Full body — circuit	40 min
Circuit — 3 rounds, 45 sec rest between rounds	All 4 exercises back-to-back then rest	3 rounds
Bodyweight squat		12 reps
Knee push-up		8 reps
Glute bridge		12 reps
Plank hold		20 sec
Note: Circuit improves cardiovascular fitness alongside strength — key for PCOS metabolic health.		
Saturday	Restorative yoga	35 min
Legs up the wall	Cushion under hips if available.	5 min
Supported child's pose	Pillow between thighs and chest if available	3 min
Reclined bound angle	Soles of feet together, knees fall open.	4 min
Yoga nidra (guided)	YouTube: "10 min yoga nidra" — lie and listen	10 min
Note: After 5 active days, body needs this. PCOS recovery requires parasympathetic time.		
Sunday	Complete rest	—
Full rest day — no exercise	Meal prep, cook your batch items for the week	—
Assess Week 3 in diary	What felt strong? Hard? Energy vs Week 1?	15 min
Note: You have now done 5 active days this week. Week 4 introduces dumbbells.		
Week 3 rule	Get a light resistance band (Rs 200–400 on Amazon — loop band, medium resistance). You should feel a mild burn by the last rep of each set — that is the target. If you do not feel it, add one more set, not more reps.	

Week 4 — Full programme

Arrive at the full ongoing plan · Introduce dumbbells · Feel capable and consistent

Duration 40–50 min/day	Intensity Moderate–high — 6–7/10	Equipment Light dumbbells 2–4 kg	Active days 6 of 7
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Monday	Lower body — dumbbells	45 min
Goblet squat — 2 kg	Hold dumbbell at chest. Sit deep. Elbows inside knees.	3 x 12 reps
Romanian deadlift — 2 kg each hand	Hinge at hips, weights slide down thighs, back flat.	3 x 10 reps
Reverse lunge — bodyweight	Step back, not forward. Easier on knees.	3 x 10 each leg
Glute bridge with band above knees	Push knees out against band at top.	3 x 15 reps
Standing calf raise — slow	3 sec up, 3 sec down. Single leg when ready.	3 x 15 reps
Note: 2 kg feels light. Correct. Perfect form now enables heavier loads next month safely.		

Tuesday	Yoga — full practice	35 min
Full sun salutation sequence	5 rounds, steady breath. You know this now.	5 rounds
Warrior I, II, III sequence	Warrior III needs balance — use wall if needed.	Each side x2
Boat pose — full leg extension	Try straightening legs if core is ready	Hold 20 sec x4
Yin finish	Dragon pose + sleeping swan + savasana	10 min
Note: By Week 4, yoga feels familiar. You are building a skill, not just stretching.		

Wednesday	Upper body — dumbbells	45 min
Full push-up (on toes) — or knee	Straight line from head to heel. No sagging hips.	3 x 8 reps
Dumbbell shoulder press — seated — 2 kg	Sit tall, press above head, lower with control.	3 x 10 reps
Dumbbell bent-over row — 2 kg each	Hinge forward, elbows drive back. Works back.	3 x 10 each side
Plank — full on hands	Straight-arm plank. Aim 25–30 seconds.	3 x 25 sec
Dead bug — slow, 5 sec per rep	Fully controlled. No rushing.	3 x 6 each side
Note: Row and shoulder press are most important for posture — desk workers need these urgently.		

Thursday	Power walk	35 min
Power walk — brisk pace	Arms swinging, chest up, fast but not running.	30 min
Cool-down walk + stretch	Bring heart rate down gradually	5 min
Note: Power walking is underrated for PCOS — sustained moderate intensity improves insulin sensitivity.		
Friday	Full body — Week 4 circuit	45 min
Circuit — 3 rounds, 60 sec rest between rounds	Back-to-back then rest	3 rounds
Goblet squat — 2 kg		12 reps
Push-up (full or knee)		8–10 reps
Dumbbell row — 2 kg each		10 each side
Glute bridge with band		15 reps
Plank hold		25 sec
Note: Compare to Week 3 circuit. Heavier, longer, harder. Feel proud of that difference.		
Saturday	Yoga + breath	35 min
Your full chosen yoga flow	By now you know what you like. Do that.	25 min
Nadi Shodhana pranayama	Most important 10 min of the week for anxiety + PCOS.	10 min
Note: End of Month 1. You have rebuilt the habit, foundation, and confidence. Month 2: progressive overload.		
Sunday	Rest + Month 1 review	—
Complete rest — you have earned it	No exercise today	—
Month 1 review in diary	Energy? Sleep? Mood? Soreness? Consistency? Write it all.	15 min
Note: 4 weeks consistent exercise is exactly when it becomes automatic behaviour, not willpower. You crossed it.		
Week 4 rule	Start with 2 kg dumbbells — lighter than you think you need. Perfect form with light weight builds neuromuscular patterns needed for heavier loads next month. You can always go heavier next week. This is your transition into Month 2.	